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Submitter Information

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General Comment

Artificial intelligence development should not be allowed to train off of copyrighted content without explicit consent of owner (and the owner must be given free will in the choice). It is especially so if AI companies and organizations profit off of it and receive funding to do it. This so-called “freedom of intelligence” undermines the “freedom of creative independence”. Which of those created the objects, movements, inventions, medicines, concepts, stories, software, and so much more that still impact and guide us today? Will an amalgamation of data save us, or the ingenuity of individuals? How come AI even exists today? Raw human intelligence, not data generated from a machine.

Allowing AI companies to source their training data off of copyrighted material destroys our American value of individuality and creativity. Copyright was instilled to promote the legendary American entrepreneurial spirit, to keep people constantly creating something new, pushing the boundaries of the known into the unknown. If AI gets a pass from all the copyright laws, it undermines that core value. In this pursuit of power, it will take away individuality, ownership, and punish creativity. All because the AI companies want to be better than competitors.

We, the common folk, didn’t ask for this. We absolutely didn’t ask for this. We were force fed all this artificial intelligence in all of our digital lives by companies against our interests in the name of profit and pleasing stakeholders. Now these companies are begging the government to take our data, our creations, our written thoughts, our stories, our passions, our photos, our digital lives, in the name of “national security”? We do not want this.

This is essentially plagiarism. Taking content that they do not own and do not credit in the slightest and use it for profit. Even if they use it for “the greater good” and make it non-profit, it doesn’t make it legal nor morally right. This is worse than imminent domain. If we can punish both children and well known scholars for using material that they do not credit, why do these companies get free rein?

If the national security is under threat because AI companies can’t fill up their databases with information that doesn’t belong to them, then perhaps it is the American intelligence that is lowering. If we must solely rely on a program algorithm with a high fail and hallucination rate to save us, who are we? AI isn’t a need, it is a mere tool. Do not let this tool tell you it’s worth it all. For all we may know, this may very well be a marketing ploy of technological elites. Besides, who truly benefits it from all? Not we the people, that’s for certain. We are no longer customers or citizens. We have been reduced to data.

We do not want this.